Benchmark Diagnostics

The Lab Report: March 2026

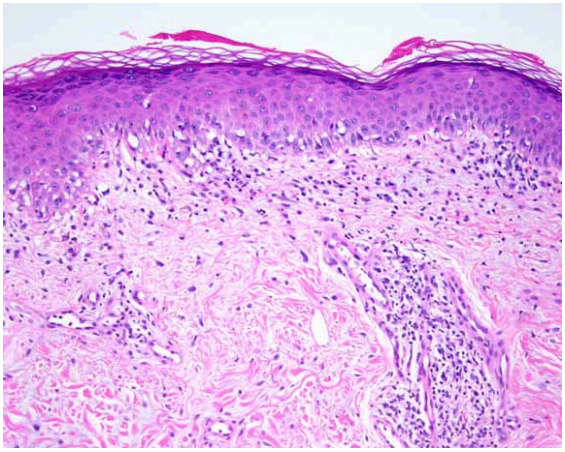
Insights Beyond The Diagnosis

Anti-TIF-1 Dermatomyositis: High Incidence of Malignancy

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Anti-TIF-1 Dermatomyositis: Screen For Malignancy

The association of dermatomyositis with internal malignancies is well known; however, among all dermatomyositis-associated autoantibodies, anti-TIF-1γ (Transcription Intermediary Factor-1 gamma) has emerged as the strongest cancer-associated marker.

Anti-TIF-1γ subtype DM affects older people, with a female-to-male ratio of 2:1. The rash is more widespread and has a darker tone.
These patients do not usually develop interstitial lung disease. Other differences in clinical presentation include dysphagia and telangiectasia of the nail unit.
Malignancy is often observed within 1 year of rash onset. Common organs affected are Ovary, Lung, Pancreas, Gastric, Colorectal, and Breast.

Clinical Pearls

- Age of onset > 50 years
- Rash: more widespread and darker
- Nail fold telangiectasia and bleeding
- Presence of dysphagia
- No dyspnea (Lack of ILD)
- Myalgia less common than othe variants

Harada Y, Tominaga M, Iitoh E, Kaieda S, Koga T, Fujimoto K, Chikasue T, Obara H, Kakuma T, Ida H, Kawayama T, Hoshino T. Clinical Characteristics of Anti-TIF-1γ Antibody-Positive Dermatomyositis Associated with Malignancy. J Clin Med. 2022 Mar 30;11(7):1925. doi: 10.3390/jcm11071925. PMID: 35407533; PMCID: PMC8999723.

"Questions or cases to discuss? We're always happy to review."